
Paper 3, Option 38.2:

The making of modern China, 1860–1997

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore the ways in which China has been transformed economically and its changing relationship with the outside. China's problems might have appeared almost insoluble in the late nineteenth century: a once great country and civilisation was perceived as economically backward and incapable of defending itself, but by the end of the twentieth century, its wealth was doubling every 10 years and it was economically the second most powerful state on earth.

Aspects in breadth: industrialisation and the making of an economic titan, 1860–1997	
Themes	Content
1 The growth of industry	- Improved communications and the application of western technologies, 1860–1997 (key developments: the growth of railways, steam ships for coastal and river traffic in the later Qing Empire, telegraphy and road building in the 1930s, air transport in the later twentieth century). - The growth of mining and manufacturing, 1860–1997 (key developments: the growth of textile production in Shanghai in the later Qing Empire, developments in Manchuria under the Japanese in the 1930s, the first Five-Year Plan 1953–57, electrical power, technological innovation in the digital age).
2 Ideologies and individuals behind economic growth	- Ideas and ideologies as factors promoting change, 1860–1997 (key developments: the Self-Strengthening Movement of the 1860s and 70s, the cult of science and rejection of traditional values in the May Fourth Movement 1915–24, Marxism and the Soviet inspired cult of heavy industry in the early 1950s, modifying soviet Marxism and 'walking on two legs' 1958, the embrace of capitalism in the 1980s and 90s). - The roles of individuals in promoting economic growth, 1860–1997: Li Hongzhang, Sheng Xuanhuai, Sung Tzu-wen [TV Soong], Mao Zedong, Deng Xiaping (key developments: the establishment of the first modern bank in China 1897, the China Development Finance Corporation in the 1930s, the Great Leap Forward 1958–61, the launch of the Four Modernisations 1978).

Aspects in depth: China and the outside	
Key topics	Content
1 Opening up China to foreigners, 1860–70	• The terms and significance of the Treaty of Tianjin 1860. • Treaty ports and the significance of growing foreign trade; the British in Shanghai and penetration of the Yangtze valley. • The impact of the spread of foreign language schools, teaching English and French; growing awareness amongst the elite of other cultures and ideas; the impact of missions and missionaries; the Tianjin massacre of 1870 and its immediate consequences.
2 Defeat and humiliation, 1894–1901	• The significance of the Sino-Japanese War of 1894–95: causes and consequences; the Treaty of Shimonoseki and the loss of Taiwan and Korea. • The impact of the Triple Intervention and concessions to France, Russia and Germany. The role of Britain and the granting of new concessions: Weihaiwei and Hong Kong's New Territories. • The significance of the Boxer Rebellion, 1898–1900: causes, and the attitude of Empress Cixi; events and consequences.
3 The Japanese threat, 1931–41	• The significance of the Manchurian Crisis of 1931–33; Jiang Jieshi's (Chiang Kai-shek) response; the loss of Manchuria and conflict in Shanghai; the treaty of Tanggu. • The reasons for all-out war 1937; the Marco Polo Bridge Incident; the fight for Shanghai August–November 1937. • The impact of war, 1937–39; the seizure of the coast; the rape of Nanjing; the retreat to Chongqing. The role and importance of the USA, 1940–41; the significance of 7 December 1941 for China.
4 The Sino-Soviet split, 1958–69	• The significance of Russian demands in 1958 and the clash of personalities between Khrushchev and Mao. The breakdown of relations, 1959–60; private insults, public disagreements. • The reasons for, and importance of, Mao's growing fears of the Soviet Union, its intervention in Chinese affairs and the perceived Russian threats to his position, 1961–68. • The significance of military confrontation in 1969.
5 Reconciliation with old enemies and the return of Hong Kong, 1978–97	• The significance of China's growing importance in world organisations: the UN Security Council, IMF and the World Bank; increasing diplomatic ties throughout the world. • The significance of closer cooperation with Japan; treaties, trade, diplomatic visits. Significance of improved relations with the USA: full diplomatic relations 1979, Deng's visit to the USA 1979 and Jiang Zemin's 1997; growing trade.